

The Welcome Checklist

THE WELCOME CHECKLIST

Best practices for greeting newcomers in the Young Adult Ministry.

1. The First 5 Minutes

- Station greeters at the entrance, not just inside the room.
- Smile, make eye contact, and introduce yourself by name.
- Avoid overwhelming questions. Stick to: "Is this your first time?", "How did you hear about us?", "Are you from the area?"

2. The Hand-Off

- Never leave a newcomer alone. Introduce them to at least one other person with a shared interest or similar life stage.
- Example: "Hey Sarah, this is John. He also just moved here for grad school!"

3. The Environment

- Ensure signage is clear (where are the bathrooms? where is the coffee?).
- Play background music to eliminate awkward silence before the event begins.
- Provide name tags (and make sure core leaders wear theirs too!).

4. The Follow-Up (Within 48 Hours)

- Send a short, personalized text or email.
- Do NOT make it a generic mass message.
- Example: "Hey John, it was great meeting you on Tuesday! Hope your week is going well. See you next time."

5. What NOT to Do

- Don't ask them to read or pray out loud on their first day.
- Don't push them to sign up for a volunteer team immediately.
- Don't assume they have a church background; avoid insider jargon.